

TOPIC 4: STRUCTURE

TYPES OF SENTENCES IN STRUCTURE

Simple, compound, complex, and compound complex sentences

There are different types of sentences based on structure. They include; simple, compound, complex and compound complex sentences

A. Simple Sentence

A simple sentence contains one idea and one verb. It consists of one independent clause. Examples

1. Rose went to the market
2. She bought a lot of goods

B. Compound Sentence

Compound sentence is a sentence which contains two or more independent clauses that are joined together by co-ordinating conjunctions like; and, but, either or, neither nor. The major feature of compound sentence is that it can contain two or more ideas.

Examples

1. Rose went to the market and she bought a lot of goods
2. John came yesterday and saw his bag on the table.
3. He came, he saw and he conquered
4. She tried hard but failed in her attempt
5. We can either eat spaghetti or take some wine.

C. Complex Sentence

A complex sentence contains one main clause and one or more subordinate/independent clauses.

Examples;

1. This is the boy who was caught stealing oranges

Here, the second idea depends on the first to make a complete sense.

“This is the boy” is the main clause while; “Who was caught stealing oranges” is the dependent clause.

2. When the rain stopped, the dancing competition continued.

“When the rain stopped” is a dependent clause that derives its complete meaning from the main clause “the dancing competition continued”.

D. Compound Complex Sentence

A compound complex sentence contains two main clauses and at least one or more dependent clauses.

Examples

1. We ate the food which was kept on the dining table for us but we were not satisfied. The above compound complex sentence can be broken thus;
 - i. We ate the food but we were not satisfied (compound sentence containing two independent clauses).
 - ii. Which was kept on the dining table for us (dependent clause). Therefore, compound complex sentence contains two independent clauses.

More examples:

1. While the children were sleeping, the dog stole into the room and ate the raw meat.
2. Your creditor came yesterday, when you were not at home, and asked after you but I was able to pay him.

Assignment

1. Give 2 examples of simple and compound sentences.
2. Mention the features of complex and compound complex sentences
3. Mention the difference between the compound sentence and the complex sentence.